

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Counseling psychology; emerging adulthood; social-emotional development; intervention research; psychotherapy process and outcomes; sleep and emotion regulation; self-concept and self-esteem; longitudinal and person-centered methods; multicultural adjustment.

EDUCATION

National Taiwan University

Taipei, Taiwan

Ph.D. Coursework in Psychology

2022.09–2023.09

- GPA: 4.26/4.30
- Minor: Big Data and Digital Assessment Program

National Taiwan University

Taipei, Taiwan

M.Sc. in Psychology

2017.09–2021.06

- Laboratory of Socioemotional Development
- GPA: 3.84/4.30
- Master's Thesis (A+): *The Intervention Effect of the Self-Concept Curriculum Designed by Taiwan Happiness Village Association on Children with Diverse Initial States.*
- DOI: 10.6342/NTU202104178

Sun Yat-sen University

Guangzhou, China

B.A. in Anthropology

2013.08–2017.06

- Major GPA: 3.9/4.0
- Bachelor's Thesis (92/100): *Visitor Behavior and Educational Effects in a Safari Park: A Mixed-Methods Study*
- Selected Undergraduate Research: *Personality Development and Educational Change among Adolescents in Rural Yao Communities* — a month-long ethnographic field study of rural education, left-behind children, caregiving contexts, and adolescent development.

MANUSCRIPTS

- **Li, Y., & Tan, R.** (under review). Do parental cognitions affect children's mental health? An empirical study in central China based on theories of intergenerational transmission and social learning. *Journal of Child and Family Studies*.

CONFERENCE & ACADEMIC PRESENTATIONS

- **Li, Y., Xue, R., He, X., & Guo, Z.** (2022, December). Care and Support for "Swing Players": Preliminary Development of a CBT- and IPSRT-Based Therapeutic Group for Individuals with Bipolar I Disorder. *Poster presented at the Mental Health Social Work Poster Exhibition, Department of Social Work, National Taiwan University, Taipei, Taiwan.*
- **Li, Y., Lay, K. L., Lin, C. Y., Chang, T. C., Yang, L. J., Chen, H. T., & Wang, Y. J.** (2019). Differential SEL effect for children with diverse initial states: I. The self-concept curriculum designed by Taiwan Happiness Village Association. *Poster presented at the 7th ENSEC Conference, Budapest, Hungary, August 2019; and the 7th NTU Psychology Department Research Exchange and 2019 NTU–Peking University–Chinese University of Hong Kong Psychology Academic Exchange, Taipei, Taiwan, May 2019.*
- **Lin, C. Y., Lay, K. L., Li, Y., Yang, L. J., & Chen, H. T.** (2019, August). When an SEL program is implemented without community partnership: Differential SEL effect for children with diverse social economic status. *Poster presented at the 7th ENSEC Conference, Budapest, Hungary.*
- **Cheng, C., Lay, K. L., Lin, C. Y., Li, Y., Chang, T. C., Yang, L. J., Chen, H. T., & Wang, Y. J.** (2019, August). Differential SEL effect for children with diverse initial states II: The communication-skill curriculum designed by Taiwan Happiness Village Association. *Poster presented at the 7th ENSEC Conference, Budapest, Hungary.*

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Independent Research Project

Researcher & Data Analyst

Remote
2026.08–Present

Secondary reanalysis of master's thesis data from National Taiwan University

Project: Person-Centered Reanalysis of Longitudinal Self-Concept Data from a School-Based SEL Study

- Conducting a secondary reanalysis of the longitudinal dataset originally used for the master's thesis on differential effects of a school-based social-emotional learning intervention.
- Applying Latent Profile Analysis (LPA) across multiple waves to identify heterogeneous profiles of children's scholastic and social self-concept.
- Applying Latent Transition Analysis (LTA) to examine profile stability and transitions over time.
- Conducting BCH-based distal outcome analyses to compare global self-worth across latent profiles.
- Current analyses identify recurring high, moderate, low, and domain-imbalanced self-concept profiles and suggest transitions toward more balanced self-concept patterns for some children over time.

Shanghai Normal University

Researcher & Group Presenter

Shanghai, China
2025.08

Project: "Who Are We Eating For?": Food Sharing, Self-Presentation, and Identity Construction on Social Media

Program: "Go to the Field" Digital Field Research 2025 Summer Training Camp

- Conducted digital ethnographic research on how young adults use everyday food practices and food-related social media content to negotiate relationships, identity, emotional experience, and transitions into adult roles.
- Contributed to a collaborative digital field study synthesizing semi-structured interview data from 64 young adults across multiple regions of China and served as presenter for the final group research presentation.
- Conducted an individual mixed-method sub-study using purposive sampling, semi-structured interviews, and photo-elicitation with 14 valid participants aged 18–35, examining food-image sharing, self-presentation, relational meaning, and autobiographical memory across digital platforms.
- Identified platform-specific self-presentation strategies, with strong-tie platforms such as WeChat functioning more as socially regulated "front stages," while weaker-tie or more anonymous platforms enabled comparatively flexible and personal forms of expression.
- Found that food images functioned not only as records of consumption but also as relational and emotional objects through which participants maintained social ties, reconstructed family memories, expressed identity, and negotiated meanings of everyday life.
- Conducted an exploratory pre-post analysis of Rosenberg Self-Esteem Scale scores for nine participants. Mean self-esteem increased from 31.67 to 32.67; although the change was not statistically significant, the estimated effect size was moderate ($d = 0.485$).
- Reflected on photo-assisted narrative interviewing as a potential mechanism for self-reflection, autobiographical meaning-making, and emotional expression.
- Received the First Prize Scholarship in the "Go to the Field" Digital Field Research 2025 Summer Training Camp.

National Taiwan University

Research Assistant & Group Co-Leader
Department of Social Work

Taipei, Taiwan
2022.09–2023.09

Project: Construction of a Trauma-Informed, Recovery-Oriented Care System for Women with Substance-Use and Trauma Histories

Advisor: Prof. Hui-Ching Wu

Grant: NSTC 110-2410-H-002-135-SS2

- Evaluated a localized Trauma Recovery and Empowerment Model (TREM)-based group intervention for women with co-occurring substance-use and trauma histories.
- Co-facilitated a 12-session trauma-informed group program at a community addiction treatment center and Taoyuan Women's Prison, leading selected sessions focused on trauma, coping, and recovery.
- Contributed to a mixed-method longitudinal intervention study involving 69 women in the intervention group and 40 women in the comparison group, assessed at pre-treatment, post-treatment, and 3-, 6-, and 10-month follow-ups.
- Integrated standardized measures of trauma symptoms, psychological distress, addiction severity, resilience, and recovery with in-depth interviews and structured field observations.

- Findings indicated that group differences in trauma impact, daily functioning, coping, resilience, and recovery narrowed over time.
- Participants also reported improvements in emotion regulation, self-awareness, self-protection, interpersonal relationships, problem solving, resource use, future orientation, and perceived group safety.

Guangzhou College of Commerce

Intervention Designer & Data Analyst

Guangzhou, China

2021.07–2022.09

Project: Mindfulness and Photo-Diary Psychological Interventions for University Students

- Designed and implemented large-scale psychological interventions incorporating mindfulness practice, photo-based reflection, experiential activities, and mental health education.
- Developed and facilitated the “21-Day Soul Camera” photo-diary program, engaging more than 800 faculty members and students.
- Led the “Mindfulness Journey” intervention with 1,001 participants, with a focus on psychological well-being and sleep quality.
- Collected pre–post psychological outcome data and conducted intervention-effect analyses.
- Applied repeated-measures analyses and estimated marginal means (EMMs) to examine changes across assessment occasions.

National Taiwan University

Research Assistant & Data Analyst

Taipei, Taiwan

2018.06–2021.06

Department of Psychology, Laboratory of Socioemotional Development

Project: Developmental Trajectories of Emotional Competence and Effects of a School-Based Social-Emotional Learning Curriculum in Preadolescence

Advisor: Prof. Keng-Ling Lay

Grants: MOST 106-2410-H-002-078-SSS; MOST 107-2410-H-002-121-SSS

- Led data management and cleaning for a multi-informant dataset involving more than 2,000 students, parents, and teachers in a two-year, six-wave longitudinal study.
- Examined developmental trajectories of emotional intelligence, self-concept, self-esteem, peer interaction adjustment, and problem-solving skills and evaluated differential effects of a large-scale school-based SEL curriculum.
- Applied Autoregressive Latent Trajectory (ALT) and multi-group ALT models to four-wave self-concept and self-esteem data.
- Conducted descriptive statistics, item analyses, internal consistency checks, independent-samples *t*-tests, correlations, EFA, CFA, SEM, Latent Growth Curve Modeling, ALT, and Multi-Group ALT models.
- Conducted additional analyses of emotional intelligence using paired *t*-tests, ANOVA, ANCOVA, correlations, regression, and moderation analyses with child- and parent-reported data.
- Developed a coding system for open-ended problem-solving responses; recruited and trained undergraduate coders, coordinated team-based coding, and assessed inter-rater reliability.
- Analyses indicated positive intervention effects in selected domains of children’s self-perception, including social competence, global self-worth, scholastic competence, and behavioral conduct, with effects differing across domains and time points.
- Findings formed the empirical basis of the master’s thesis and a first-author presentation at the 2019 ENSEC Conference.

National Taiwan University

Research Assistant & Data Analyst

Taipei / Beijing

2018.02–2019.02

Department of Psychology, Laboratory of Socioemotional Development

Project: Longitudinal Evaluation of a Culturally Adapted Social-Emotional Learning Program for School-Age Children in Beijing

Advisor: Prof. Keng-Ling Lay

- Contributed to a multi-school longitudinal evaluation of a culturally adapted SEL curriculum implemented with fourth-, fifth-, and seventh-grade students in Beijing.
- Analyzed multi-informant student and parent data collected within a two-year, five-wave longitudinal study of emotional intelligence.
- Examined emotional intelligence across emotion appraisal and expression, emotion regulation, and utilization of emotion.

- Conducted pre–post comparisons and ANCOVA analyses to evaluate intervention–control differences while adjusting for baseline scores.
- Applied hierarchical regression and moderation analyses to examine whether parenting styles and parent–child attachment predicted intervention-related gains and moderated associations between baseline emotional intelligence and subsequent improvement.
- Results indicated heterogeneous intervention effects across grades, schools, and reporters, with some groups showing improvement relative to comparison groups and others showing limited or mixed effects.

National Taiwan University

Course Research Project

Department of Psychology, Laboratory of Socioemotional Development

Project: Maternal Beliefs and Goal Orientations in Predicting Preschoolers' Goal Choice in a Challenging Context

Advisor: Prof. Keng-Ling Lay

- Examined associations between maternal beliefs, achievement-goal orientations, and preschoolers' motivational choices and performance in a challenging task context.
- Worked with data from a study of 77 preschoolers and their mothers involving maternal questionnaires and a researcher-developed iPad visual-search task, *Finding Where's Rabbit*.
- Prepared and organized mother–child questionnaire and behavioral-task variables for statistical analysis.
- Conducted correlation and regression analyses examining relations among maternal implicit beliefs, achievement-goal orientations, and children's motivational outcomes.

Taipei, Taiwan

2018.02–2018.06

Sun Yat-sen University

Undergraduate Thesis Researcher

School of Sociology and Anthropology

Project: Visitor Behavior and Educational Effects in a Safari Park: A Mixed-Methods Study

Advisor: Prof. Peng Zhang

- Conducted a mixed-methods undergraduate thesis examining visitor behavior, viewing preferences, and educational experiences in a large safari park.
- Combined behavioral observation, participant observation, interviews, and questionnaires.
- Observed 507 visitor groups across six animal exhibits and systematically recorded viewing duration, visitor behaviors, animal activity, exhibit conditions, and visitor density.
- Collected pre-visit survey and interview data on visitor preferences and expectations, together with naturalistic verbal-response data during exhibit visits.
- Applied hierarchical regression, contingency analyses, and Mann–Whitney U tests in SPSS.
- The final hierarchical regression model explained 42.8% of the variance in viewing duration; animal activity, behavioral demonstrations, visitor density, and several forms of visitor engagement were associated with longer viewing times.

Guangzhou, China

2017.02–2017.05

Sun Yat-sen University

Student Researcher

School of Sociology and Anthropology

Project: Household Labor Division and Gender-Role Expectations in Hakka Families: A Qualitative Case Study

Advisor: Prof. Xunxiang Xia

- Conducted a qualitative case study examining how modernization and urbanization reshaped household labor division and gender-role expectations in contemporary Hakka families.
- Used participant observation and in-depth interviews to document changes in family labor allocation following a temporary disruption to the household's usual division of labor.
- Compared cases across generations and family types, including urban Hakka households, dual-earner families, younger-generation families, and Hakka–non-Hakka marriages.
- Analyzed how gender-role expectations were reproduced, negotiated, and transmitted through everyday family interactions, intergenerational socialization, and conflicts between traditional and modern values.
- Findings suggested that household labor practices had become more flexible under modernization, while underlying gender-role expectations remained comparatively persistent.

Guangdong, China

2016

Sun Yat-sen University

Guangxi, China

Project: Education and Adolescent Development in Rural Yao Communities

Advisor: Prof. Tongxue Tan

- Conducted a month-long anthropological field study in Gongcheng Yao Autonomous County examining rural education, child and adolescent development, and the experiences of left-behind children.
- Combined participant observation, interviews, and psychological measures to investigate educational environments, caregiving contexts, and factors related to children's psychological adjustment and personality development.
- Interviewed rural teachers and school administrators about school consolidation, boarding education, teacher mobility, intergenerational caregiving, and children's adaptation.
- Examined how parental labor migration, grandparent caregiving, educational resources, and minority cultural and language contexts shaped children's schooling experiences.
- Produced a nearly 30,000-character field report, *Personality Development and Educational Change among Adolescents in Rural Yao Communities*.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Community Program

Leuven, Belgium

Volunteer Group Facilitator

2026.05

Program: *Rooted & Blooming: A Self-Exploration Group for Graduate Students*

- Designed and facilitated a free small-group self-exploration workshop for master's and doctoral students experiencing academic stress, uncertainty about the future, cross-cultural adjustment, relational concerns, and questions of self-worth.
- Integrated mindfulness, botanical collage, photo-based reflection, OH cards, guided sharing, and life-review exercises to support emotional awareness, self-understanding, and reflection on personal strengths and growth.
- Structured the group around psychological safety, voluntary disclosure, confidentiality, and non-evaluative creative expression.

Tsinghua University

Beijing, China / Remote

Clinical Psychology Consultant

2025.09–2026.01

AI-Assisted Counseling and Human–Computer Interaction Research

- Collaborated with human–computer interaction research teams on AI-assisted psychological counseling projects examining how clinical knowledge and psychotherapy strategies can be adapted to text-based and AI-mediated counseling contexts.
- Provided domain expertise on psychotherapy processes, therapeutic approaches, case formulation, and adaptation of counseling strategies for AI-supported mental health applications.
- Developed structured clinical decision frameworks for common counseling concerns, including cross-cultural adjustment, anxiety and stress, academic procrastination, interpersonal difficulties, and identity-related concerns.
- Translated clinical reasoning into hierarchical decision pathways linking presenting concerns, assessment considerations, intervention strategies, and follow-up support.
- Participated in the AICo AI-Assisted Online Psychological Counseling research project and subsequent research on adaptive intervention processes across psychotherapy approaches.

Guangzhou Medical University

Guangzhou, China

Trainee Psychotherapist

2024.03–2024.05

The Affiliated Brain Hospital

- Rotated through outpatient and inpatient units in psychosomatic medicine.
- Participated in interdisciplinary case meetings and treatment planning.
- Observed and assisted in integrated cases involving psychotherapy and pharmacotherapy.

Tsinghua University

Beijing, China / Remote

Mental Health Helpline Counselor (Volunteer)

2023.10–Present

Wellbeing Public Welfare Hotline

- Provide real-time emotional support and crisis intervention through structured phone consultations.

- Trained in trauma-informed listening, suicide risk assessment, and active presence techniques.

Glowe Counseling Platform

Shenzhen, China / Online

Psychological Counselor

2022.09–Present

- Provide individual psychological counseling in an online private-practice setting.
- Cumulative counseling experience across university and private-practice settings exceeds 1,500 hours, with more than 250 hours of clinical supervision.
- Work with concerns including anxiety, depression, sleep difficulties, academic stress, interpersonal and intimate relationships, family-of-origin concerns, and cross-cultural adjustment.
- Receive ongoing professional supervision and case consultation.

Guangzhou College of Commerce

Guangzhou, China

Mental Health Counselor

2021.07–2022.09

Mental Health Education and Counseling Center; Student Mental Health Association Advisor

- Provided individual counseling, psychological assessment, and crisis support to university students, including intervention with more than 20 high-risk cases.
- Accumulated more than 500 hours of individual counseling in the university counseling center.
- Designed and delivered training for student peer-support volunteers, psychological letter-response volunteers, hotline responders, student mental-health representatives, and campus peer-support teams.
- Developed psychoeducational training on empathy, helping skills, emotional regulation, child and adolescent development, and Solution-Focused Brief Therapy (SFBT), including coping questions, exception questions, strengths-based responses, and supportive communication.
- Served as faculty advisor to the student mental health association and supported student-led mental-health outreach and peer-support activities.
- Designed and facilitated the “21-Day Soul Camera” photo-diary mental health program, engaging more than 800 faculty members and students.
- Designed and facilitated the “Mindfulness Journey” program with 1,001 participants, incorporating mindfulness practice, emotional awareness, and self-care.
- Designed and led a photo-based psychological group program that received First Prize in a Guangdong Province college mental health competition.
- Integrated mindfulness, photography, reflective writing, group discussion, and experiential activities into campus mental-health programming.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Fu Jen Catholic University

New Taipei City, Taiwan

Guest Lecturer

2023.05

Department of Clinical Psychology

Lecture: Qualitative and Mixed Methods Research

- Delivered an invited lecture on qualitative and mixed-methods research to students in the Department of Clinical Psychology.
- Introduced core characteristics and validity criteria of qualitative research, including reflexivity, triangulation, interpretive validity, theoretical validity, and transferability.
- Taught major qualitative approaches, including phenomenology, ethnography, case study research, and grounded theory, as well as concurrent and sequential mixed-method designs.
- Developed accompanying practice questions and assessment materials to support students’ understanding of qualitative and mixed-method research design.

Guangzhou College of Commerce

Guangzhou, China

Psychology Lecturer

2021.09–2022.08

- Independently developed and taught modules on mental health literacy, emotion regulation, stress management, and interpersonal skills.
- Delivered a two-semester mental health education course to approximately 700 undergraduate students.
- Received an average student satisfaction rating of 4.71/5.

National Taiwan University

Taipei, Taiwan

Teaching Assistant

2018.02–2019.01

- Teaching Assistant, *Socioemotional Development*.
- Teaching Assistant, *Psychology of Adolescence*.

METHODOLOGICAL COMPETENCIES

- **Data Processing:** Variable coding, data cleaning, construction of analysis-ready datasets, dummy coding, documentation of analytic decisions, and handling of missing data.
- **Reliability Analysis:** Development of coding systems; inter-rater reliability using Cohen's κ ; test-retest reliability; internal consistency analysis.
- **Descriptive & Inferential Statistics:** Descriptive statistics, Pearson's r , t -tests, ANOVA, ANCOVA, non-parametric tests, and effect-size estimation.
- **Predictive Modeling:** Multiple regression, hierarchical regression, and moderation analysis.
- **Latent Variable Modeling:** Exploratory Factor Analysis (EFA), Confirmatory Factor Analysis (CFA), and Structural Equation Modeling (SEM).
- **Longitudinal & Person-Centered Modeling:** Latent Growth Curve Modeling (LGCM), Autoregressive Latent Trajectory (ALT) modeling, multi-group ALT, Latent Profile Analysis (LPA), Latent Transition Analysis (LTA), and BCH distal outcome analysis.
- **Qualitative & Mixed Methods:** Ethnographic and digital ethnographic fieldwork, participant observation, behavioral observation, semi-structured and life-history interviews, photo-elicitation, qualitative case analysis, thematic interpretation, questionnaire methods, and mixed-method research.
- **Intervention & Program Evaluation:** Pre-post intervention design, longitudinal intervention evaluation, repeated-measures analysis, and multi-informant assessment.
- **Workshop-Based Training:** Cross-cultural research and longitudinal developmental data analysis.

PROFESSIONAL REGISTRATION & CREDENTIALS

Chinese Psychological Society	China
<i>Registered Clinical and Counseling Psychologist</i>	2024.01–2026.12
<i>Clinical and Counseling Psychology Registration System</i>	
• Registration No. X-24-276	

National Professional Credential	China
<i>Psychological Therapist, Level I</i>	Valid indefinitely
• Certificate No. 30220230422010030327	

National Professional Credential	China
<i>Social Worker, Level I</i>	Valid indefinitely
• Certificate No. 20220603844000003270	

SCHOLARSHIPS & AWARDS

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| • First Prize Scholarship, “Go to the Field” Digital Field Research 2025 Summer Training Camp, Shanghai Normal University | 2025.08 |
| • Encouragement Scholarship, National Taiwan University | 2024.03 |
| • Xingang LIFE House Outstanding Volunteer, Sun Yat-sen University | 2015.12 |

LANGUAGES & TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **English Proficiency:** IELTS Academic 7.5 overall (Listening 8.0, Reading 8.0, Writing 6.5, Speaking 7.0).
- **Languages:** Mandarin Chinese, Cantonese, Hakka, and English.
- **Statistical Software:** SPSS, Mplus, SAS, R, and LISREL.